## Unit – 5

### Road Safety

Good morning, everybody. Firstly, I would like to thank the headmaster for inviting me to speak on road safety in conjunction with "Road Safety Week".

Lately, there have been many road accidents in our district. In most cases, they occurred due to carelessness and recklessness : speeding, flouting traffic rules, driving vehicles which were not roadworthy and driving under the influence of drugs or alcohol.

Last week alone, we received about four accident reports per day, with most of the accidents occurring during dusk and peak hours. Out of these, more than half were serious, in which victims had to be hospitalized.

Many of you present here already have driving licenses and the rest will get yours soon. What I want to impress upon you today is that you must make road safety your top priority. Do not take your driving license as a license to kill or to use roads as you like.

Drive or ride carefully and be considerate to other road users. When you are on the road, observe traffic rules and road ethics. Above all, be alert and keep calm. There may be times when you have to give way to other vehicles or let cars overtake you. Do not take this as an insult or a challenge to your pride. It could lead to violence on the road.

I know some youngsters enjoy the thrill of speeding and testing the capability of their machines. They enjoy listening to the revving of their bikes, riding at breakneck speed and overtaking vehicles dangerously. Tell me, what do you get by speeding ? Well, you may reach your destination faster but how much faster ? One minute ? Two ? Is it worth the risk of being involved in accidents, or worse still, being maimed or killed ? It's not worth it -- not worth your money, not worth your life. However, if you still feel generous and would like to donate your money to us, then speed by all means. I assure you we'll give you a ticket.

Common sense sense should prevail at all times. these are some practical rules on road safety you should always bear in mind.



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